

FIGHTING WITHDRAWAL: A **fighting withdrawal** may be used in combat if the defender wishes to back up slowly. Movement backwards is limited to $\frac{1}{2}$ the normal movement rate per round (or less). There *must* be enough room to back up. In crowded situations, characters or monsters behind a creature attempting to use a fighting withdrawal will prevent this form of defensive movement.

RETREAT: Any movement backwards at more than $\frac{1}{2}$ the normal movement rate is a **retreat**. If a creature tries to retreat, the opponent may add +2 to all "to hit" rolls, and the defender is not allowed to make a return attack. In addition to the bonus on "to hit" rolls, the attacks are further adjusted by using the defender's Armor Class *without a shield*. (Any attacks from behind are adjusted in the same manner.)

EXAMPLE: Huxley (a fighter) wears plate mail armor and shield, for an Armor Class of 2. He opens a door and is surprised by a gargoyle. He doesn't have a magic weapon, so he can't hurt it. He tries to use a **fighting withdrawal** to let the other fighter get into the battle. Although the new fighter has a magic weapon, the gargoyle keeps attacking Huxley; he gets hit again. He decides to **retreat**. If the gargoyle attacks him again, his Armor Class is 3, and the gargoyle may add +2 to its "to hit" rolls.

How To Attack

In combat, attacks may be made with spells (magical attack), weapons which are shot or thrown (missile fire), or weapons which are held and swung (hand-to-hand or melee combat).

Spell attacks will automatically hit the chosen targets if within range or the area of effect. There is a chance that a character may escape all or part of the effects of certain spells. This chance is called a **saving throw**, and is a combination of luck and experience. Saving throws are fully explained on page B26.

A melee or missile fire attack does *not* automatically hit. The chance of an attack hitting or being successful is given as a number between 1 and 20 and is determined by comparing the attacker's level or hit dice to the defender's armor class (AC) on the tables below. One table is used when characters (PCs or NPCs) are attacking, and the other is used when monsters are attacking. **Roll 1d20: if the result is equal to or greater than the number indicated by the chart, the attack has been successful.** Unless magical or silver weapons are needed to cause damage, (and not available) a roll of **20** will **always** hit, and a roll of **1** will always **miss**.

ADJUSTMENTS TO ATTACK ROLLS: Both missile fire and melee combat use the same **Attack** tables. Missile fire may occur when the opponents are more than 5' apart, but only when a thrown weapon (a spear, for example) or a shot missile weapon (such as by a bow) is being used. In missile fire combat, the score needed "to hit" may be adjusted by Dexterity, magical weapons, missile range and special situations (for example, having cover from missile fire — such as a barrel to hide behind).

Melee combat may occur if the opponents are within 5' of each other. In melee combat, the score needed "to hit" may be adjusted by Strength, magical weapons, and by occasional special situations. Unless missile attacks are mentioned, monsters will *only* engage in melee combat.

Missile fire is never adjusted by Strength. Hand-to-hand combat is never adjusted by Dexterity. A character may not attack more than once in one round.

ATTACKS ON "UNHITTABLE" CREATURES (OPTION): Some creatures can be hit only by silvered or magic weapons. The DM may want to allow two other kinds of attack to hit such creatures. First, attacks by other "unhittable" creatures may be allowed (for

example, a lycanthrope could attack a wight). Second, attacks by monsters with more than four hit dice may be allowed (an owlbear could attack a wererat).

DAMAGE

If an attack hits, the DM must determine how much damage the attack has done. Damage from attacks by monsters is given with each monster description. The most common series of monster attacks is the "claw/claw/bite routine". Damages are always listed in the order of the attacks. For example, a cave bear has 3 attacks (2 claws and 1 bite); its attacks will do damages of 1-8 (1d8) points from each claw and 2-12 (2d6) points from the bite. This is listed as 1-8/1-8/2-12.

AMOUNT OF DAMAGE: All weapon attacks by characters (PC or NPC) will do 1-6 (1d6) points of damage, adjusted by Strength and magical bonuses, if applicable. If the **Variable Weapon Damage** system (hereafter) is used, check the weapon type to find how much damage each weapon will do (adjusted by Strength and magical bonuses or penalties).

SCORING DAMAGE: The number of points of damage caused by a successful attack is immediately subtracted from the number of hit points the defender has at that time. All damages remain until healed. Any defender reduced to 0 hit points or less is dead.

HEALING WOUNDS: Wounds may be cured in two ways: by resting or by magic. To cure wounds by resting, the wounded creature must *relax* in a safe place, and may *do nothing but rest*. Each full day of complete rest will restore 1-3 hit points (roll 1d6; 1 or 2 indicates 1; 3 or 4 indicates 2; 5 or 6 indicates 3). If a day's rest is interrupted for any reason, no healing will take place. Wounds may also be healed by certain clerical spells and some magic items. Spells will heal wounds instantly without the need for long rest.

Different methods of healing may be used together: a character might rest 1 full day and also be healed by a **cure light wounds** spell in the same day.

Missile-Fire

Missile fire is a type of combat used when the enemy is too far away to fight hand-to-hand (more than 5 feet away). Missile weapons include crossbows (which fire quarrels), short and normal bows (which fire arrows), slings (which throw sling stones), thrown axes hammers, spears, flasks of oils, and vials of Holy Water. Missile fire is adjusted by Dexterity adjustments, the range to the target, any cover the target has, and any magical adjustments, as explained hereafter. Most monsters do not use missile fire (unless mentioned in the monster description).

Missile fire is fought at a range beyond 5 feet but still within sight. The DM should first check to be sure that the range is not greater than the maximum range for the type of weapon to be used (see **Missile Fire Ranges**, hereafter). The DM must check for surprise (or initiative) to see which side fires first. If the distance between enemies is reduced to 5' or less as a result of movement, hand-to-hand combat may take place. In one round, a character may move and fire missiles or move and fight hand-to-hand. A character may not fire missiles, move, and start hand-to-hand combat all in the same round. A character may not attack twice in one round.

DEXTERITY: Missile fire may be adjusted by a character's Dexterity adjustment, see page B7. The Dexterity adjustment will either add to or subtract from the "to hit" die rolls for missile fire, but does not adjust the damage caused.